

# Checklist

## Standards and Procedures

### Documentation Hierarchy

- ☐ **The policy** clearly explains **why** the organization requires the control or rule.
- ☐ **Standards/manuals** define **what** requirements must be followed.
- ☐ **Procedures** identify **who performs activities, when, and where**.
- ☐ **Work instructions, guidelines, and SOPs** explain **how** specific tasks are performed.
- ☐ Each document is placed at the correct level of the documentation hierarchy.
- ☐ Related policies, standards, procedures, and work instructions are clearly linked.

### Standards

- ☐ Standards provide technology-specific requirements without unnecessary procedural detail.
- ☐ Standards support and expand upon applicable policy requirements.
- ☐ Requirements use clear, mandatory language such as **must**, **shall**, or **will**.
- ☐ Ambiguous wording such as **should**, **try**, or **mostly** is avoided where a requirement is mandatory.
- ☐ Requirements are specific enough to be consistently implemented.
- ☐ Standards avoid duplicating detailed information already maintained elsewhere.
- ☐ Common requirements are documented once and referenced by applicable policies.
- ☐ Standards are maintained separately where doing so improves usability and maintainability.
- ☐ Changes to standards can be made centrally without requiring unnecessary changes to multiple policies.
- ☐ Standards are reviewed regularly for technical accuracy.

### Procedures

- ☐ Procedures explain how standards are implemented on specific technologies or platforms.
- ☐ Procedures contain enough detail for the intended audience to complete the task consistently.
- ☐ Platform-specific procedures are created where technologies require different implementation steps.
- ☐ Steps are listed in the order in which they must be performed.
- ☐ Instructions use the active voice.
- ☐ Grammar and wording are clear.
- ☐ Assumptions and prerequisites are explicitly stated.
- ☐ Assumptions are verified as valid.
- ☐ Instructions are concise and avoid unnecessary wording.
- ☐ Technical terminology and jargon are used only where appropriate.
- ☐ Commands, settings, configuration values, or examples are included where needed.
- ☐ Procedures allow appropriate judgment where overly prescriptive instructions would be impractical.
- ☐ Procedures are reviewed by people who understand both the technology and the intended audience.

## **Consistency and Knowledge Distribution**

- ☐ Standards and procedures support consistent implementation of organizational policies.
- ☐ Requirements can be applied equally across relevant teams and systems.
- ☐ Documentation reduces reliance on institutional or legacy knowledge.
- ☐ Employees can locate the information they need without relying on specific individuals.
- ☐ Documentation is understandable to new employees and personnel outside the original authoring team.
- ☐ Documentation clearly communicates organizational expectations.
- ☐ Information is organized so users can quickly find the appropriate document.
- ☐ Repetition between policies, standards, and procedures is minimized.

## **Regulatory and Management Requirements**

- ☐ Applicable laws, regulations, contractual requirements, and compliance frameworks have been identified.

- ☐ Required policies, standards, and procedures exist to support applicable compliance obligations.
- ☐ Relevant regulatory or legal references are included where appropriate.
- ☐ Documentation can be readily provided during an audit or compliance review.
- ☐ Standards and procedures have appropriate management endorsement.
- ☐ Required approvals are documented.
- ☐ Documentation demonstrates that responsible management has accepted the requirements.

## **Required Document Contents**

### **Version Information**

- ☐ Document version number is included.
- ☐ Effective date is included.
- ☐ Revision or update date is included where applicable.
- ☐ Current and obsolete versions can be clearly distinguished.
- ☐ A revision history is maintained where appropriate.

### **Owner and Approver**

- ☐ Document owner is identified.
- ☐ Required approver or approving authority is identified.
- ☐ Approval has been formally recorded.
- ☐ Ownership information allows users to submit questions, feedback, or revision requests.
- ☐ Responsibility for future review and maintenance is clear.

### **Purpose / Overview**

- ☐ The document contains a brief purpose or overview.
- ☐ The purpose explains what the document is intended to accomplish.
- ☐ The overview allows readers to quickly determine whether the document is relevant to them.
- ☐ The overview is concise and generally limited to a short paragraph where possible.

### **Scope**

- ☐ The scope identifies who or what the document applies to.
- ☐ Applicable employees, contractors, departments, systems, applications, or technologies are identified.
- ☐ Any exclusions are clearly stated.
- ☐ Organizational or technical boundaries are unambiguous.

## **Statements / Requirements**

- ☐ Requirements or procedural statements are clearly identified.
- ☐ Statements are concise and unambiguous.
- ☐ Requirements can be objectively understood and applied.
- ☐ Statements are reviewed regularly for accuracy.
- ☐ Technical requirements reflect the current environment.
- ☐ Obsolete instructions are removed or updated promptly.

## **Related Documents**

- ☐ Applicable policies are referenced.
- ☐ Applicable standards are referenced.
- ☐ Applicable procedures, processes, work instructions, or SOPs are referenced.
- ☐ Related documents can be easily located.
- ☐ Applicable regulatory, legal, or compliance references are included where useful.
- ☐ Cross-references are kept current when related documents change.

## **Naming and Organization**

- ☐ Consistent naming conventions are used for policies, standards, procedures, and supporting documents.
- ☐ Referenced systems, technologies, roles, and artifacts use consistent terminology.
- ☐ Document names clearly indicate their purpose.
- ☐ Documents are stored in an approved, accessible repository.
- ☐ Users can determine which document is authoritative.
- ☐ Superseded documents are archived or marked obsolete.
- ☐ Access permissions are appropriate for the intended audience.

## **Final Quality Review**

- ☐ The document is written for the skill level of its intended readers.

- ☐ The document is easy to read and navigate.
- ☐ Language is simple, direct, and consistent.
- ☐ Requirements do not conflict with higher-level policies.
- ☐ Procedures correctly implement the applicable standards.
- ☐ Work instructions and SOPs correctly implement the applicable procedures.
- ☐ Technical information has been validated.
- ☐ The document has been reviewed by appropriate subject-matter experts.
- ☐ The document has received all required approvals.
- ☐ A review frequency or next review date has been established.
- ☐ The final approved version has been published and communicated to relevant users.